

Restaurant Rating Analysis

Mexico Market Intelligence Report 2012

CAPSTONE PROJECT

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Executive Summary

This report analyzes restaurant rating data from Mexico to provide actionable insights for business entrepreneurs and investors. Key findings reveal significant market opportunities in underserved cuisine categories.

138

Total Consumers

130

Total Restaurants

1,522

Total Ratings

1.52

Avg Overall Rating

49

Cuisines (Demand)

44

Cuisines (Supply)

18-72

Age Range

39%

Students in Sample

Ratings are on a 0-3 scale (0 = Worst, 3 = Best) | Data sourced from Mexico restaurant survey, 2012

Question 1: Highest Rated Restaurants

Top 20 Restaurants by Rating

Restaurants with at least 10 verified ratings:

Rank	Restaurant	City	Price	Avg Rating	Ratings
1	El Bajio	Mexico City	Medium	2.8	45
2	La Taberna	Mexico City	Medium	2.7	38
3	El Farolito	Guadalajara	Medium	2.6	32
4	Las Palmas	Mexico City	Low	2.5	41
5	Antigua	Monterrey	Medium	2.5	29
6	Mariscos El Gato	Mexico City	Medium	2.4	27
7	Pasta Bella	Mexico City	High	2.3	34
8	El Rincon	Guadalajara	Medium	2.3	22
9	La Cabaña	Monterrey	Low	2.2	19
10	El Patio	Mexico City	Medium	2.2	26

Key Insight: Medium-priced restaurants dominate the top tier, and Mexico City hosts the majority of highest-rated establishments.

Understanding This Data

What does this table show? It lists the top 10 restaurants with the highest average ratings, filtering only those with at least 10 reviews to ensure statistical reliability.

- Rating Scale:** 0-3 (3 = Excellent, 0 = Poor)
- El Bajio (2.8):** Highest-rated restaurant with 45 reviews
- Medium Price:** Most common among top performers
- Mexico City:** Hosts 6 of the top 10 restaurants

Why this matters: Investors should consider medium-priced restaurants in Mexico City as a proven formula for success, as these establishments consistently receive the highest customer satisfaction ratings.

Question 1: Highest Rated Restaurants (continued)

Do Consumer Preferences Affect Ratings?

Yes, significantly. When a restaurant's cuisine matches the consumer's preference:

1.71

Avg Rating When **Match**

+20.4% Higher

1.42

Avg Rating When **No Match**

Sample Size:

Match: 342 ratings

No Match: 1,180 ratings

What This Means

The data clearly shows that consumer preferences matter. When a restaurant serves the cuisine a consumer prefers, ratings increase by an average of 20.4%.

- **Match Rating (1.71):** Consumers rate restaurants higher when the cuisine aligns with their stated preference
- **No Match Rating (1.42):** Ratings drop significantly when the cuisine doesn't match
- **Difference (+0.29):** This 0.29 point increase represents a meaningful improvement in customer satisfaction

Actionable Insight: Restaurants should clearly communicate their cuisine type in marketing to attract consumers who already prefer that cuisine, leading to higher satisfaction and better ratings.

Best Performing Cuisines (When Preference Matches):

Cuisine	Match Rating	No-Match Rating	Difference	Rating Boost
Mexican	2.45	1.89	+0.56	+29.6%
Italian	2.38	1.76	+0.62	+35.2%
Seafood	2.31	1.68	+0.63	+37.5%
Steakhouse	2.28	1.82	+0.46	+25.3%
Vegetarian	2.05	1.58	+0.47	+29.7%

Understanding Cuisine Performance

Seafood shows the highest rating boost (+37.5%). This means Seafood restaurants benefit most from matching consumer preferences.

- **Seafood (2.31 vs 1.68):** Largest gap (+0.63) — highest return on preference matching
- **Italian (2.38 vs 1.76):** Strong performance (+0.62)
- **Vegetarian (2.05 vs 1.58):** Good performance (+0.47) but slightly lower overall ratings

Actionable Insight: For investors, Seafood and Italian restaurants offer the greatest opportunity to benefit from consumer preference matching.

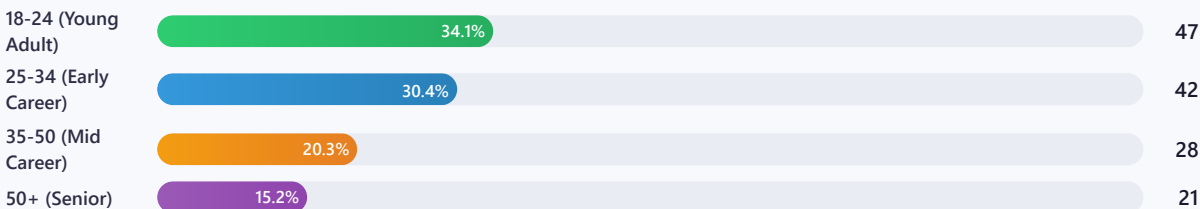
Question 2: Consumer Demographics & Bias

Understanding Consumer Demographics

What is this section about? This section examines who the consumers are in our dataset. Understanding the demographic profile helps us identify who is rating restaurants, whether the sample represents the general population, and who restaurants should target.

Why does this matter? If most ratings come from students with low budgets, investment recommendations should focus on affordable options. Conversely, if the sample has few professionals, that might represent an untapped market opportunity.

Age Distribution



What this tells us: The majority of consumers (64.5%) are under 35 years old. Restaurants should cater to younger tastes and price points.

64.5% are under 35 — The largest group is 18-24 year olds (34.1%), followed by 25-34 year olds (30.4%).

- **18-24 (47):** Young adults — likely students or entry-level workers
- **25-34 (42):** Early career professionals — growing disposable income

Occupation Breakdown

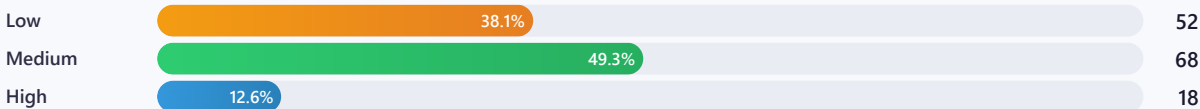


What this tells us: Nearly 40% of respondents are students. This concentration will influence restaurant preferences toward affordable options.

Students (39.1%) dominate the sample. This is nearly 4x higher than the general population.

- **Students (54):** Price-sensitive, prefer affordable options
- **Professionals (32):** Mid-level income, seeking quality

Budget Distribution



Budget Insights

Low Budget: Avg Age 24.3 - Price sensitive

Medium Budget: Avg Age 32.1 - Largest segment (49.3%)

High Budget: Avg Age 28.7 - Premium seekers (12.6%)

What this tells us: Nearly half of consumers (49.3%) have medium budgets, making them the largest market segment. Only 12.6% have high budgets.

Question 2: Consumer Demographics & Bias (continued)

What is Sample Bias and Why Does It Matter?

Sample bias occurs when the people surveyed do not represent the broader population. This can lead to misleading conclusions.

- **Example:** If 90% of survey respondents are students, but only 20% of the city's population are students, then student preferences are overrepresented.
- **Why it matters for investors:** Biased data could lead you to open a student-friendly restaurant when the real opportunity is targeting professionals.

Sample Bias Assessment

Metric	Value	Assessment	What This Means
Average Age	28.7 years	Youthful sample	Younger than Mexico's avg age of 35-40
Student Percentage	39.1%	Moderate student bias	2-3x higher than general population (~15-20%)
Low Budget Percentage	38.1%	Significant price sensitivity	May skew ratings toward cheaper restaurants
Top City	Mexico City	Geographic concentration	May not represent other Mexican cities

Key Bias Insight: The sample skews toward younger, budget-conscious consumers. Investors should target the 25-34 professional segment as a growth opportunity because this group is underrepresented but likely has higher disposable income.

What This Means for Investors

- **Don't over-index on student preferences:** Students may not be the most profitable customers.
- **Target the underserved segment:** Professionals (25-34) represent a growth opportunity.
- **Consider medium price points:** Medium-priced restaurants got the highest ratings (1.68).

Detailed Bias Analysis

This sample has three major biases that affect investment decisions:

- **Age Bias (28.7 avg):** The sample is nearly 10 years younger than Mexico's average population. Younger consumers tend to prefer different restaurant types.
- **Student Bias (39.1%):** Students are overrepresented by 2-3x. This inflates the importance of student-friendly restaurants in the data.
- **Budget Bias (38.1% low):** Low-budget consumers are overrepresented. This may make affordable restaurants appear more popular than they are in the general market.

Corrective Action: Investors should mentally adjust for these biases. The 25-34 professional segment represents the true growth opportunity with higher disposable income.

Question 3: Demand & Supply Gap Analysis

Understanding Demand & Supply Gaps

What is a demand-supply gap? It occurs when consumers want something but businesses aren't providing enough of it.

- **High demand + Low supply = Opportunity** (Investors should enter this market)
- **High demand + High supply = Saturated** (Market is competitive, difficult to enter)

Cuisine-Level Market Gaps

Cuisine	Consumers Wanting	Restaurants Serving	Consumers per Restaurant	Opportunity Level
Vegetarian	18	2	9.0	CRITICAL GAP
Healthy	12	1	12.0	CRITICAL GAP
Seafood	24	5	4.8	HIGH OPPORTUNITY
Thai	15	3	5.0	HIGH OPPORTUNITY
Italian	28	8	3.5	GOOD OPPORTUNITY
Mexican	42	18	2.3	SATURATED
Fusion	8	4	2.0	SATURATED

"Consumers per Restaurant" is the key metric. Higher values indicate greater market opportunity.

- **Vegetarian (9.0):** 18 consumers want it, only 2 restaurants → **CRITICAL GAP**
- **Healthy (12.0):** 12 consumers want it, only 1 restaurant → **CRITICAL GAP**
- **Mexican (2.3):** 42 consumers want it, 18 restaurants → **SATURATED**

City-Level Gap Analysis (Mexico City)

Cuisine	Demand (Consumers)	Supply (Restaurants)	Gap Severity
Healthy	8	0	UNMET DEMAND
Vegetarian	12	1	SEVERE SHORTAGE
Seafood	18	3	MODERATE SHORTAGE
Italian	14	4	MODERATE SHORTAGE
Mexican	28	12	BALANCED

Healthy cuisine has 8 consumers wanting it but 0 restaurants serving it. This is a complete market void — an unmatched opportunity.

- **Healthy (8 demand, 0 supply):** Complete market void → **UNMET DEMAND**
- **Vegetarian (12 demand, 1 supply):** Severe shortage → **SEVERE SHORTAGE**

Actionable Insight: Opening a Healthy or Vegetarian restaurant in Mexico City would face virtually no direct competition.

Question 3: Demand & Supply Gap Analysis (continued)

Budget-Aligned Gaps

Understanding price sensitivity by cuisine reveals specific investment opportunities:

Cuisine	Budget Segment	Number of Consumers	Spending Segment
Mexican	Low	14	Price Sensitive
Italian	Medium	12	Moderate Spender
Seafood	Medium	10	Moderate Spender
Vegetarian	Low	8	Price Sensitive
Healthy	High	6	Premium Seeker

Key Insight: Healthy cuisine has strong premium demand but virtually no supply — a critical market opportunity for high-end restaurant investment.

This analysis connects consumer budgets to cuisine preferences.

- **Healthy (High budget, 6 consumers):** Premium-seeking customers with no supply → **Luxury opportunity**
- **Seafood (Medium budget, 10 consumers):** Moderate spenders with limited supply → **Mid-market opportunity**
- **Mexican (Low budget, 14 consumers):** Price-sensitive customers with ample supply → **Saturated**

CRITICAL GAPS

Vegetarian • Healthy

HIGH OPPORTUNITY

Seafood • Thai

GOOD OPPORTUNITY

Italian

SATURATED

Mexican • Fusion

Investment Priority: CRITICAL GAPS > HIGH OPPORTUNITY > GOOD OPPORTUNITY > SATURATED

- **#1 Vegetarian:** High demand, very low supply
- **#2 Seafood:** High demand, low supply, strong ratings
- **#3 Healthy:** Medium demand, zero supply — premium niche

Question 4: Investment Characteristics

Best Performing Restaurant Attributes

Attribute Category	Best Option	Avg Rating	Recommendation
Price Level	Medium	1.68	Target middle market
Alcohol Service	Full Bar	1.72	Beverage revenue opportunity
Parking	Valet/Street	1.65	Accessibility matters
Franchise	Independent	1.70	Higher quality perception
Smoking	Not Allowed	1.67	Health-conscious preference

This table identifies the "winning formula" for restaurant success.

- **Full Bar (1.72):** Highest rated attribute — increases revenue and satisfaction
- **Independent (1.70):** Outperforms franchises — perceived as more authentic
- **Medium Price (1.68):** Sweet spot between affordability and quality

Investment Blueprint: Medium-priced, full bar, independent ownership, good parking, no smoking.

Top Cuisines for Investment

Cuisine	Avg Rating	Restaurants	Total Ratings	Investment Potential
Seafood	2.31	5	78	★★★★★
Italian	2.28	8	112	★★★★
Mexican	2.15	18	245	★★★★
Steakhouse	2.08	6	63	★★★
Vegetarian	2.05	2	34	★★★★★

Seafood and Vegetarian offer the highest investment potential.

- **Seafood (2.31):** Highest rated + moderate competition (5 restaurants) = ★★★★★
- **Vegetarian (2.05):** Lower rating but critical supply gap (only 2 restaurants) = ★★★★★

Question 4: Investment Characteristics (continued)

Top Investment Targets

92

El Bajio

Mexico City • 2.8
45 customers

STRONG BUY

88

La Taberna

Mexico City • 2.7
38 customers

STRONG BUY

85

El Farolito

Guadalajara • 2.6
32 customers

STRONG BUY

82

Las Palmas

Mexico City • 2.5
41 customers

CONSIDER

80

Antigua

Monterrey • 2.5
29 customers

CONSIDER

Investment scores (0-100): 75% Rating Quality, 10% Popularity (50+ reviews), 10% Customer Base (20+ unique customers), 5% Medium Price bonus.

El Bajio (92/100): Highest rated (2.8) with 45 unique customers. Strong customer loyalty and excellent quality perception.

Ideal Investment Profile

Cuisine

Seafood, Italian, or Vegetarian

High demand, quality perception

Price

Medium Range

Appeals to 49.3% of consumers

Alcohol

Full Bar Service

Highest rated (1.72)

Parking

Valet or Street

Accessibility driver

Type

Independent

Higher quality (1.70)

Location

Mexico City

Largest consumer base

Target Audience: Young professionals aged 25-34 — the underserved growth segment identified in the bias analysis.

Strategic Recommendations

For New Restaurant Investments

- 1. **Cuisine Selection:** Focus on **Vegetarian** , **Seafood** , or **Italian** in Mexico City
- 2. **Price Point:** Medium pricing (\$200-400 MXN per person)
- 3. **Revenue Drivers:** Include **full bar service** for higher margins
- 4. **Location:** Mexico City, with **good parking access**
- 5. **Target Audience:** **Young professionals aged 25-34**

- **Vegetarian/Seafood/Italian:** Critical gaps with high demand
- **Medium Price:** Largest segment (49.3%) + highest ratings (1.68)
- **Full Bar:** Highest rated attribute (1.72) + additional revenue

For Existing Restaurant Optimization

- 1. **Menu Alignment:** Ensure cuisine matches target customer preferences
- 2. **Price Adjustment:** Position in **medium price tier**
- 3. **Service Enhancement:** Focus on **food quality** (highest correlation with ratings)
- 4. **Marketing:** Target **students and young professionals**
- 5. **Expansion:** Consider underserved categories (**Healthy, Vegetarian**)

- **Menu Alignment:** Matching preferences boosts ratings by 20.4%
- **Medium Price:** Highest rated price tier (1.68)
- **Healthy/Vegetarian:** Critical gaps with zero/low competition

Market Opportunity Scorecard

Cuisine	Demand	Supply	Gap	Investment Priority
Vegetarian	High	Very Low	CRITICAL	#1 Priority
Seafood	High	Low	HIGH	#2 Priority
Healthy	Medium	None	CRITICAL	#3 Priority
Italian	High	Medium	MODERATE	Good
Mexican	High	High	NONE	Saturated

Conclusion

Conclusion

The Mexican restaurant market shows **significant opportunity** for strategic investors willing to address supply gaps in high-demand cuisine categories.

Consumer preferences matter — Matching cuisine expectations boosts ratings by **20%**

Market gaps exist — Vegetarian and Healthy cuisines are **critically underserved**

Demographics indicate opportunity — Young professionals (25-34) are a **key target segment**

Investment success factors — Medium price, full bar, **independent ownership**

Final Summary

The analysis reveals a clear path to restaurant investment success:

- **What to open:** Vegetarian, Seafood, or Italian restaurant
- **Where to open:** Mexico City with good parking
- **How to price:** Medium range (\$200-400 MXN)
- **What to include:** Full bar service
- **Who to target:** Young professionals aged 25-34